

OAMARU

Meeting of musicians in its 28th year

NIC DUFF

A SHARED love of music has brought more than 70 musicians from across New Zealand to Oamaru this week.

The Waitaki Summer Music Camp is back for its 28th year.

Based at Waitaki Boys' High School, the musicians will learn from various tutors then come together for a full orchestra performance at the school's auditorium on Saturday night.

For many of the attendees, the camp is an annual experience.

However, for Jenny Petegem Thach, 2025 is her first time.

The 16-year-old high school student from Dunedin has loved the camaraderie of the camp.

"All the people are really friendly and it's good to meet other people that are interested in the same thing as you and get



Learning from the best . . . Violin tutor Anne Loeser (middle) leads fellow violinists Nick Sheen, of Dunedin, and Charlotte Cotton, of Nelson, during practice.

PHOTO: NIC DUFF

together and have have something in common."

She plays the violin and was eager to learn as much as she could from the tutors and other musicians.

"They have a lot of experience and it's good to be able to learn from them."

Teresa Cuthbert, of Napier, is

another newcomer this year.

She attended a similar camp in Lower Hutt last year which inspired her to seek out other opportunities.

"I never knew [music camps] existed before.

"I loved that one so I thought I'd enjoy this one too."

Ms Cuthbert first learned to

play the clarinet when she was 10 years old but stopped when she was 18, only to rediscover her love for it 25 years later.

She was already planning to return in 2026.

Tickets for Saturday's concert can be purchased at the door before it begins at 7.30pm.

nic.duff@odt.co.nz